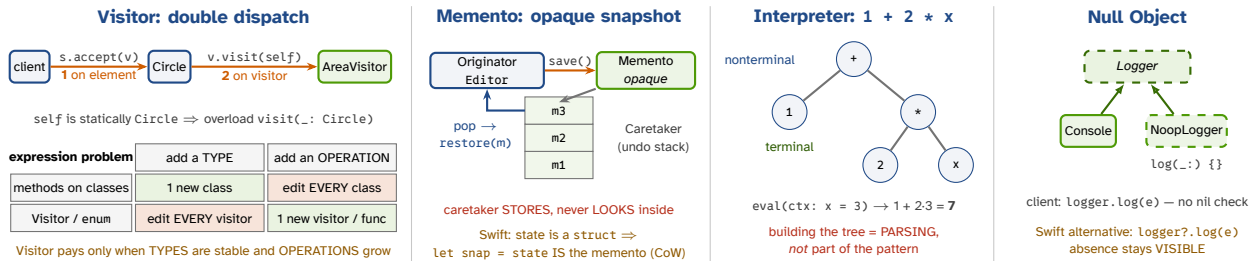


In one line: Visitor — add *operations* over a *stable* set of element types without editing them, via **double dispatch**. **Memento** — capture an object's state in an *opaque* snapshot so it can be restored (undo) without breaking encapsulation. **Interpreter** — one class per grammar rule; evaluate the **AST**. **Null Object** — a do-nothing implementation instead of `nil` checks. In Swift the first three usually become `enum` + exhaustive `switch`, value snapshots, and an indirect `enum`.



Visitor (behavioural) GoF: “represent an operation to be performed on the elements of an object structure; lets you define a new operation without changing the classes of the elements”. Roles: **Visitor** (one visit per ConcreteElement) · ConcreteVisitor · **Element** (`accept(v)`) · ConcreteElement · ObjectStructure.

Double dispatch: the code run depends on *two* runtime types; Swift/Java dispatch on the receiver only, so Visitor chains two calls: `accept` dispatches on the element, `visit(self)` on the visitor (overload picked statically).

Costs: adding an element type breaks every visitor (the **expression problem**, Wadler's name); elements must expose enough state for visitors (weaker encapsulation).

Swift: `enum` + associated values + a **function with an exhaustive switch** = a visitor with no boilerplate; a new case makes the *compiler* list every switch to fix — unless default: swallowed it. **Protocol visitor still pays** for a big node hierarchy with default traversal, where each visitor overrides only a few nodes and keeps state across the walk: `SwiftSyntaxSyntaxVisitor.visit(_:) -> SyntaxVisitorContinueKind, SyntaxRewriter`.

Memento (behavioural) GoF: “without violating encapsulation, capture and externalize an object's internal state so that the object can be restored to this state later”.

Roles: **Originator** (makes + restores) · **Memento** (wide interface to the originator, *narrow* to everyone else) · **Caretaker** (keeps them, never inspects).

Swift: state as a struct: the snapshot is a copy (CoW: cheap until a write); fileprivate fields keep it opaque; Codable persists it. iOS: state restoration (NSUserActivity, @SceneStorage).

vs Command undo: Memento stores **state** (always correct, memory-heavy → cap the depth, store diffs); Command stores the **operation + its inverse** (small, but the inverse must be exact). GoF combines them: a command keeps a memento of the before-state — as a `registerUndo(withTarget:handler:)` closure capturing the old value does.

Interpreter (behavioural) GoF: “given a language, define a representation for its grammar along with an interpreter that uses the representation to interpret sentences”. Roles:

AbstractExpression (`interpret(context)`) ·

TerminalExpression (literals, variables) ·

NonterminalExpression (one class per rule, recurses) ·

Context · Client (*builds* the AST — parsing is outside the pattern).

Fits a **small grammar where speed is not critical** (GoF's own condition). Larger or hot: a real parser + compile to closures/bytecode. **Swift:** an indirect `enum` AST + a recursive eval. **iOS you consume:** `NSPredicate` (format string → predicate tree, `evaluate(with:)`), `NSEvaluation`, `#Predicate` (a typed expression tree), `Regex`. Result builders are a *compile-time* DSL — related, not Interpreter.

Null Object (Woolf, 1998 — not GoF) A do-nothing

implementation of the protocol so clients call it unconditionally: `NoopLogger`, `EmptyAnalytics`, `SwiftUI EmptyView`, `Combine Empty`. **Swift:** Optionals already force the absence check at compile time; prefer `?.` when absence *means* something, Null Object when “absent = do nothing”. Danger: it hides a missing dependency.

```
// Visitor as enum + switch; Interpreter as indirect enum
indirect enum Expr { case num(Double), variable(String)
case add(Expr, Expr), mul(Expr, Expr) }
func eval(_ e: Expr, _ env: [String: Double]) -> Double {
switch e {
case .num(let v): v
case .variable(let n): env[n] ?? 0
case .add(let a, let b): eval(a, env) + eval(b, env)
case .mul(let a, let b): eval(a, env) * eval(b, env) } }
// Memento: value snapshots on two stacks
struct History<S> { private var undo: [S] = [], redo: [S] = []
mutating func save(_ s: S) { undo.append(s); redo.removeAll() }
mutating func undoLast(_ cur: S) -> S? {
guard let s = undo.popLast() else { return nil }
redo.append(cur); return s } }
```

Remember Visitor: types fixed, ops grow, two hops · **Memento:** snapshot you can't read · **Interpreter:** a class per rule · **Null Object:** `nil` that answers.

Traps

! **Double dispatch** is *both* hops; element types must be **closed + stable**.

! `default:` kills the exhaustiveness that replaced Visitor.

! Public getters/setters are not a Memento — it is **opaque**.

! Memento undo = **state**; Command undo = **operation + inverse**.

! Interpreter does not include the parser.